TRUSTMRR DATASET · 1,000 STARTUPS

Where to Build Next

A category opportunity analysis for a new, revenue-efficient venture

Prepared from TrustMRR data frozen 30 Jul 2026

The Market Reality

This is a power-law market — a handful of winners carry the field

$334M

Total revenue across all 1,000 companies

61%

Of all revenue held by just the top 10 companies

92x

Gap between mean ($334K) and median ($3.6K) revenue

26%

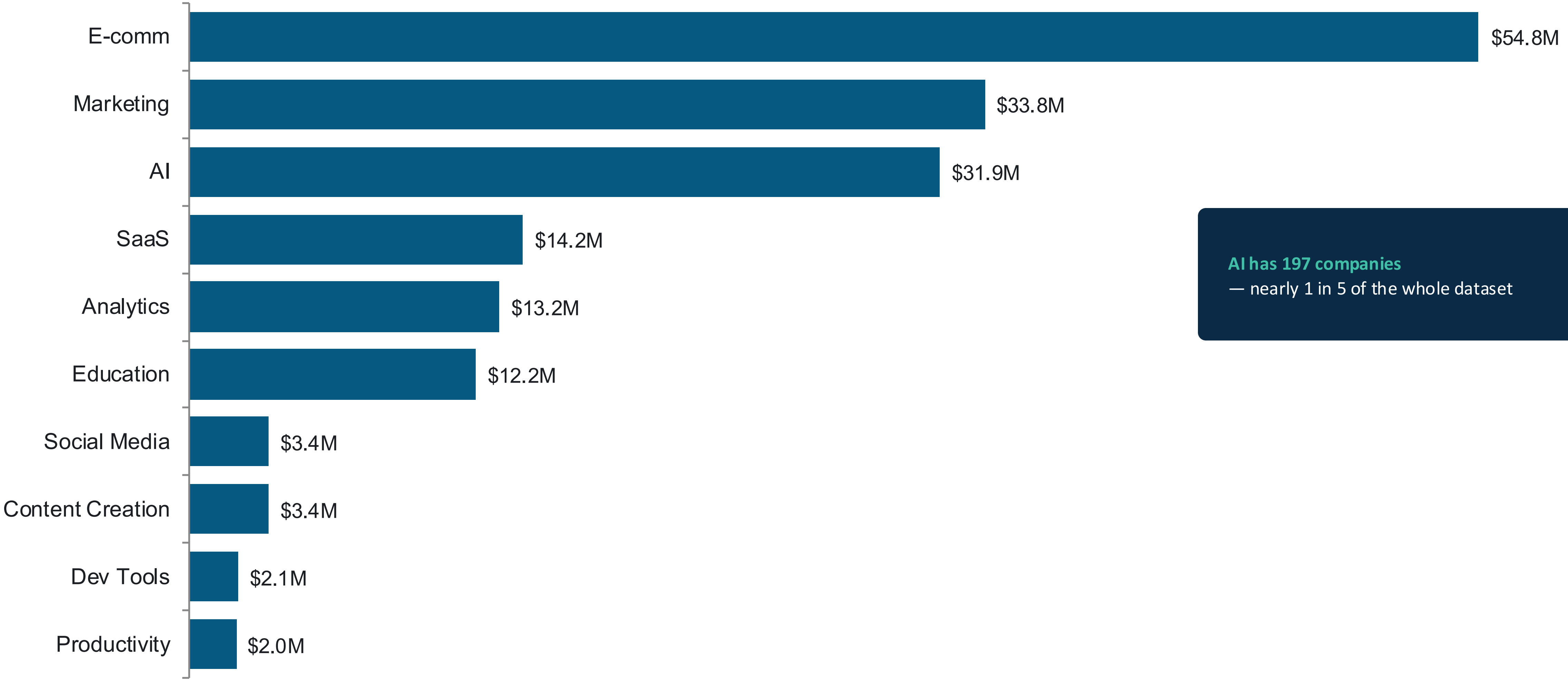
Of companies show $0 all-time revenue

What this means for a new entrant

- Chasing the biggest category isn't the same as finding an efficient one — E-comm's revenue is 93% one company (Supliful).
- Recent momentum (last-12-month share of revenue) matters more than legacy size for a new startup — it shows where demand is being created right now.

Category Revenue Landscape

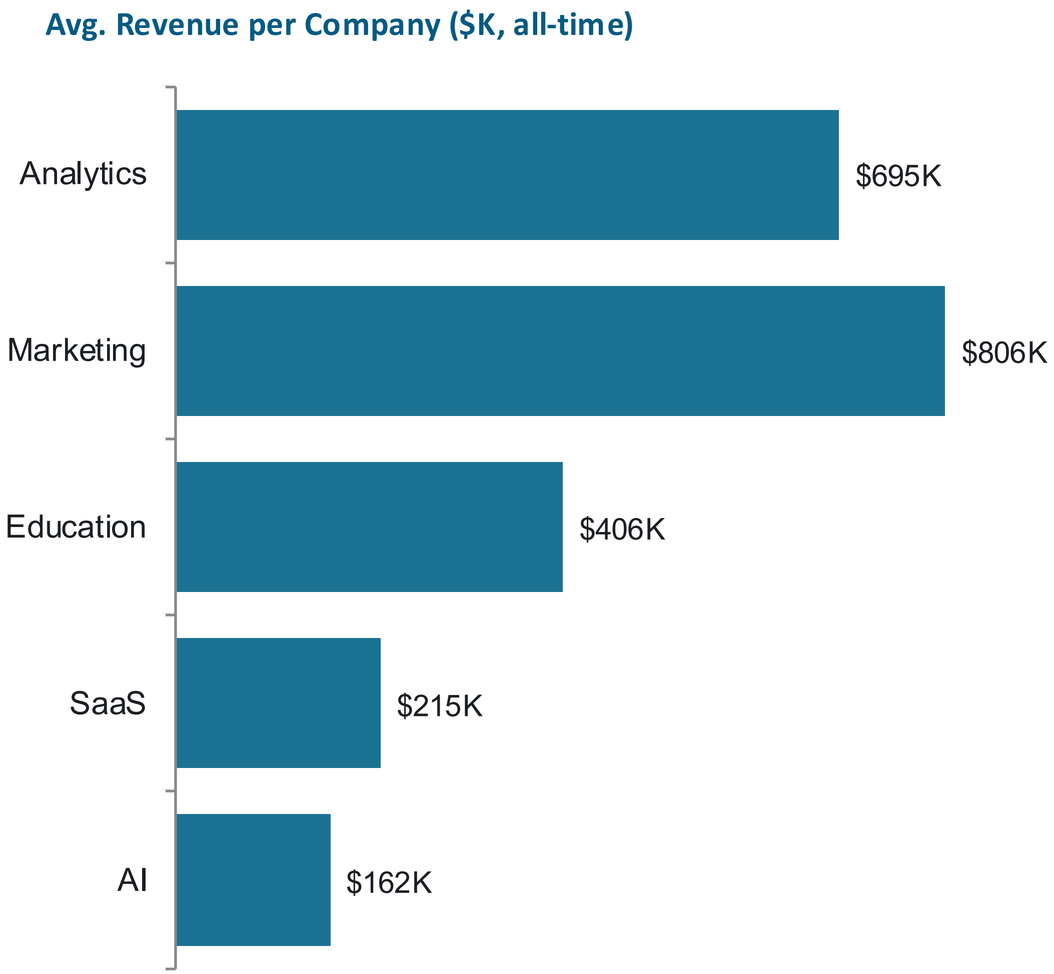
All-time revenue by category (top 10 of 29)

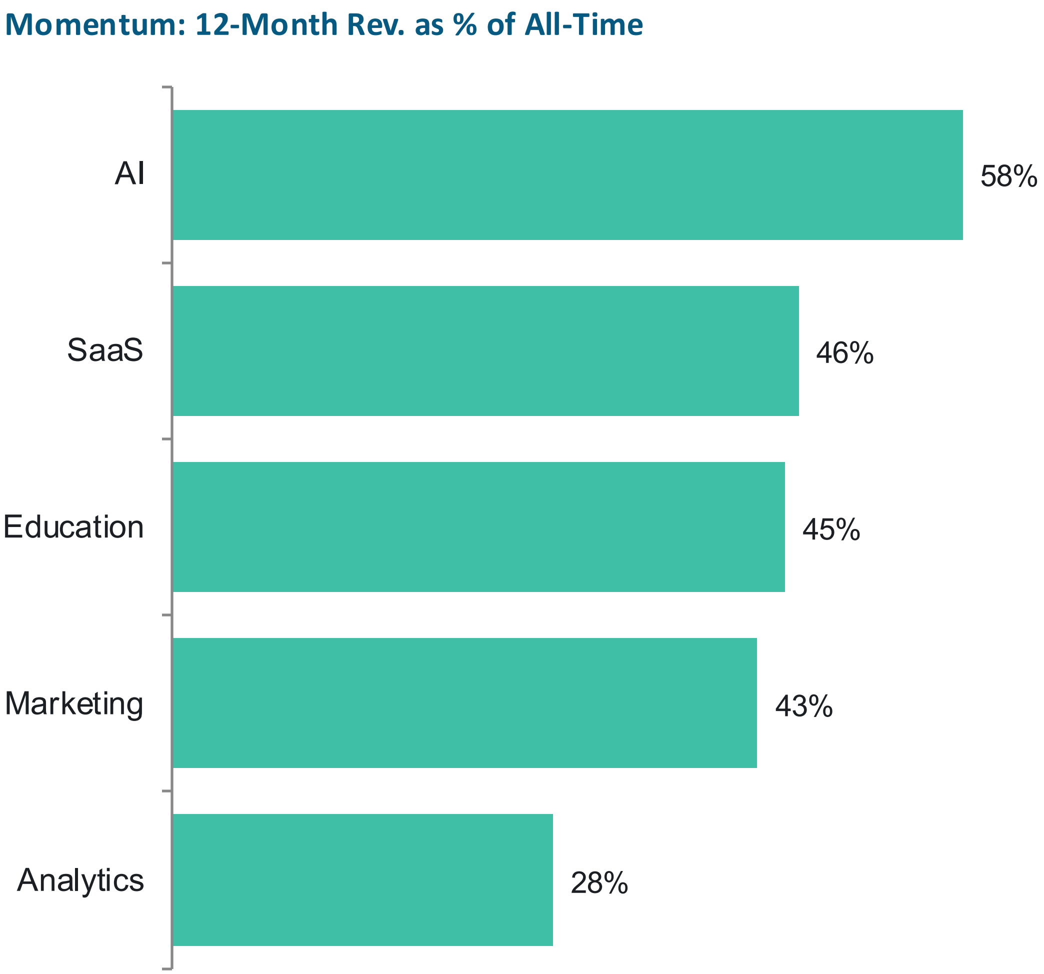


AI has 197 companies
— nearly 1 in 5 of the whole dataset

Efficiency vs. Growth Momentum

Revenue per company (efficiency) x share of revenue earned in last 12 months (momentum)





Shortlist: Where a New Entrant Is Best Positioned

Ranked by revenue-per-company efficiency, growth momentum, and room to compete

1

Analytics

HIGH EFFICIENCY

Only 19 companies, but highest revenue-per-company ($695K) of any sizeable category. Under-crowded relative to its earning power.

2

Marketing / Growth Tools

PROVEN DEMAND

$806K avg. revenue per company, $14.6M in the last 12 months alone. Strong fit coming from a marketing/e-commerce background.

3

Education

STEADY GROWTH

$406K avg. revenue per company with 45% momentum — consistent demand, moderate competition (30 companies).

4

AI (niche, not general)

HIGH MOMENTUM, HIGH NOISE

Largest and fastest-growing category (58% momentum) but 197 competitors — only a sharply defined niche stands out.

The Efficiency Playbook

What separates high-revenue companies from the rest, regardless of category

1

Sell B2B, not B2C

B2B companies earn about 5x more revenue per company than B2C ($550K vs. $108K avg.).

2

Recent momentum beats brand size

30-day revenue predicts future scale strongly (0.92 correlation) — ship and track weekly.

3

Ignore vanity metrics

X/Twitter followers show near-zero correlation with revenue. Optimize for paying users, not audience size.

4

Build on standard rails

64% of companies run on Stripe — proven, low-friction payment infra is table stakes, not a differentiator.

Recommended Path

Two efficient routes into this market — pick the one that matches your edge

Route A — Marketing / Analytics Tool

Best fit if leaning on e-commerce & marketing experience

- Sell B2B into brands and agencies — highest revenue-per-company segment
- Analytics is under-crowded (19 cos.) relative to its earning power
- Marketing has proven $14.6M in the last 12 months alone

Route B — Focused AI Niche

Best fit if targeting a specific, underserved workflow

- Ride the category with the most momentum (58%) and largest 12-month pool ($18.4M)
- Avoid general-purpose AI — 197 competitors; win one narrow, defensible use case
- Use B2B pricing from day one to escape the low-ARPU trap seen in consumer AI apps

Next Steps

1. Pick a lane using the shortlist — Analytics or Marketing for the fastest path to revenue-per-customer efficiency
2. Validate with 10-15 target buyers before building — confirm willingness to pay B2B pricing
3. Track 30-day revenue and active-subscriber growth from week one — the strongest predictor of scale in this data
4. Design for a narrow, defensible niche — the biggest categories (AI, E-comm) are also the most crowded or concentrated

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026